



POLESTAR APAC WEEKLY

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 16 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 22 SEPTEMBER 2026

REGIONAL OUTLOOK

This week's sharpest business exposure is Japan's typhoon disruption because widespread flight cancellations create an immediate constraint on staff movement and time-sensitive shipments, with the scale of evacuation guidance underscoring broader operational stress. That is a direct interruption rather than a speculative downstream risk.

A different, slower-burn issue is Nepal's LPG shortage, which points to pressure on fuel-dependent operations even though the affected locations and duration were not stated. Australia's tighter visa rules are less acute operationally, but they can reshape near-term workforce planning by narrowing some entry pathways.

WEEK AT A GLANCE

MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS	MARKETS REQUIRING WATCH	HIGH OR EXTREME DEVELOPMENTS	7-DAY WATCH ITEMS
6	6	2	4



REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The clearest transmission into business activity comes from Japan, where widespread flight cancellations can delay employee travel, disrupt meetings and impede air-linked cargo movements. That is a present service interruption. Nepal's LPG shortage is a different type of risk: the fact establishes supply stress, but not where shortages are binding, so the immediate exposure is to fuel-dependent operations that may need closer stock monitoring rather than assumed shutdowns.

Australia's visa changes work through compliance and labor access. Firms using visitor, student-family or backpacker channels may face slower mobilization or narrower staffing options once the rules are applied in practice.

Elsewhere, the facts are more conditional. The Philippines case confirms an LTFRB platform outage linked to a data-breach probe, which may hinder permit-dependent workflows, but does not establish wider transport stoppages. The Kohat attack and intensified strikes on the Shan-Karenni border elevate duty-of-care and site-access risk, yet the packet does not confirm commercial disruption beyond the incident locations.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

PAKISTAN | KOHAT KOHAT POLICE HEADQUARTERS ATTACKED

Security · Extreme · 19 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: A bomb and gun attack hit a police headquarters in Kohat, and fighting was still ongoing at the time of reporting. The source said the death toll rose to at least 31, including 16 police personnel.

POLESTAR VIEW: The attack is severe, but the facts do not confirm broader commercial access disruption beyond the police-site incident.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for any confirmed restrictions or closures affecting access around Kohat beyond the attack site.

NEPAL NEPAL LPG SUPPLY SHORTAGE

Energy · Moderate · 20 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Nepal is facing an LPG shortage linked to import problems.

POLESTAR VIEW: Supply stress is confirmed, but the packet does not show where shortages are binding or whether business activity is already curtailed.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Look for official or supplier detail on affected areas and whether deliveries are being constrained.

JAPAN FLIGHTS CANCELLED IN JAPAN

Weather & Natural Hazards · High · 21 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Typhoon Dujan caused widespread flight cancellations in Japan. Authorities urged 1.6 million people to evacuate as the typhoon affected Japan.

POLESTAR VIEW: This is the week's clearest immediate business interruption; the open question is duration, not whether disruption occurred.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Monitor whether airlines restore schedules broadly or announce further cancellations.

PHILIPPINES**LTFRB PLATFORM GOES OFFLINE****Cyber · Moderate · 19 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: LTFRB was probing a data breach after its platform went offline.

POLESTAR VIEW: An outage and breach probe are confirmed, but the facts do not show transport services broadly halted or what data was exposed.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Check for platform restoration or official guidance on interim manual processing.

AUSTRALIA**AUSTRALIA TIGHTENS VISA RULES****Regulatory · Moderate · 19 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: Australia introduced tighter migration rules targeting visa hopping and some student family and visitor pathways. Backpackers were affected by Australia's visa crackdown.

POLESTAR VIEW: The direct effect is regulatory tightening, while the practical business impact depends on which pathways remain usable once implementation detail is clarified.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for publication of rule details or implementation dates affecting targeted visa categories.

MYANMAR | SHAN-KARENNI BORDER**AIRSTRIKES INTENSIFY ON SHAN-KARENNI BORDER****Operational Disruption · Moderate · 16 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: Myanmar's military increased airstrikes and drone attacks along the Shan-Karenni border.

POLESTAR VIEW: Conflict intensity has increased, but the packet does not confirm infrastructure damage or specific business disruption.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Look for confirmed reports of specific sites hit or transport links affected near the border.

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

Logistics teams should review air-dependent movements in Japan and identify shipments or travel that cannot tolerate cancellation, because widespread flight disruptions are already confirmed. In Nepal, fuel-reliant operations should check LPG inventory buffers and supplier communication triggers, since the shortage is linked to import problems but its geographic reach is still unclear.

HR and mobility functions should recheck visa pathway assumptions for roles or seasonal staffing that use visitor, student-family or backpacker channels, because Australia has tightened migration rules aimed at visa hopping and related pathways. Any hiring or deployment decision should wait for workable route confirmation where eligibility may have narrowed.

Compliance and security teams should prepare manual workarounds where LTFRB platform access is required, as the outage is confirmed while the scope of any data exposure remains unspecified. Firms with personnel near Kohat or the Shan-Karenni border should refresh incident communication and movement approval thresholds if local conditions deteriorate further.

7 DAY WATCH

27 Sep 2026 | ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN — Planned PTI protest march

Why it matters: Movement and access in Islamabad, Pakistan may be affected by the scheduled activity.

Watch: Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

24 Sep 2026 | JAKARTA, INDONESIA — Planned Farmers' Day demonstrations

Why it matters: The planned gathering may affect access or security around Jakarta, Indonesia.

Watch: Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

24 Sep 2026 | JAKARTA, INDONESIA — Possible KSPSI employment-bill demonstration

Why it matters: The planned gathering may affect access or security around Jakarta, Indonesia.

Watch: Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

28 Sep 2026 | INDIA — Planned banking strike

Why it matters: Branch and transaction services in India may be affected by the planned banking strike.

Watch: Check banks' branch and payment-service advisories before time-sensitive transactions.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

The main regional risk is that short-lived disruption becomes a sustained constraint on movement, staffing or essential services. Security conditions in Pakistan and the Myanmar conflict area merit the closest attention for follow-on attacks or a widening of affected locations; neither establishes broader business interruption on its own. Japan's flight cancellations and Nepal's LPG shortage require different recovery tests: restored schedules would ease travel pressure, while dependable resupply would reduce fuel exposure. Confirmed business curtailment or prolonged, multi-location shortages would materially worsen that assessment.

Administrative capacity is the other regional pressure point. Australia's visa changes and restoration of the Philippines' LTFRB platform could affect workforce planning and transaction processing even as immediate disruptions ease. The clearest stabilisation signals would be service recovery and predictable implementation requirements. New access restrictions, repeated cancellations or demonstrated interruption to normal operations would justify a more cautious outlook.

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